

Chicago Tribune



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Tribune wins Pulitzer for local reporting



Coverage of Operation Midway Blitz earns top journalism honor

By Robert Channick
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The Chicago Tribune won the Pulitzer Prize for local reporting Monday for its coverage of Operation Midway Blitz, the Trump administration's immigration enforcement mission in the Chicago area last fall.

Awarded by Columbia Univer-

sity, the prize — the country's top journalism honor — recognizes exceptional coverage of significant issues of local or statewide concern. The judges cited the newsroom's comprehensive coverage of the blitz, including a story examining the federal government's raid on a South Shore apartment complex, the shooting of a U.S. citizen in Brighton Park and an investigation into how criminal charges against protesters have not withstood the harsh light of the federal court system.

The Tribune's capstone piece, "64 days in Chicago: The story of

Operation Midway Blitz," also was included in the winning entry.

"I am incredibly proud of the entire newsroom, and most proud of the way that the newsroom banded together to rise to this moment," Mitch Pugh, executive editor of the Tribune, said Monday afternoon.

The Pulitzer judges honored the coverage further by naming it a finalist for the public service medal. The Tribune has now been a finalist for that prestigious honor four times since 1980.

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Laura Rodriguez Presa, from left, Erika Slife, Adriana Perez and Gregory Royal Pratt celebrate Monday after the Chicago Tribune won the Pulitzer Prize for local reporting. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Ceasefire tested in Strait of Hormuz

US says 6 Iran boats sunk; UAE targeted; 2 cargo vessels hit

By Adam Schreck,
Ben Finley and Sam Metz
ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI, United Arab Emirates — The U.S. military said it fired on Iranian forces and sank six small boats targeting civilian ships as it moved to reopen the Strait of Hormuz on Monday. The United Arab Emirates, a key American ally, said it had come under attack from Iran for the first time since a fragile ceasefire took hold in early April.

The attacks appeared to be in response to President Donald Trump's latest efforts to reopen the strait, a crucial waterway for global energy. The U.S. military said two American-flagged merchant ships had successfully transited the strait on Monday as part of a new initiative.

The UAE Defense Ministry said its air defenses had engaged 15 missiles and four drones fired by Iran. Authorities in the eastern emirate of Fujairah said one drone sparked a fire at a key oil facility, wounding three Indian nationals. The British military reported two cargo vessels ablaze off the UAE.

Breaking Iran's chokehold on the strait would ease global economic concerns and deny Tehran a major source of leverage. But such efforts also risk reigniting the full-scale fighting that erupted when the U.S. and Israel first attacked Iran on Feb. 28, prompting it to close the strait.

Reports of new attacks raised doubts as to whether shipping companies, and their insurers, would take such a risk given that Iran has fired on ships in the waterway and vowed to keep doing so. Iran has said the new U.S. effort is a violation of the fragile ceasefire that has held for more than three weeks.

Iran's effective closure of the strait, which runs between Iran and Oman, has caused a spike in

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Dr. Jasmine Saavedra checks 12-month-old Naomi Carrera with her mother, Maria Carrera, before Naomi received some of her childhood vaccines on Monday at Esperanza Health Center in Chicago's Brighton Park neighborhood. Carrera received the MMR measles-mumps-rubella, hepatitis A, pneumococcal and chickenpox vaccinations. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Childhood vaccine rates remain high in Illinois

Amid national controversy, more than 95% received 10 required immunizations

By Lisa Schencker
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Illinois parents are continuing to get their kids vaccinated at high rates despite ongoing controversy nationally about vaccines, according to data released by the state health department Monday.

More than 95% of children statewide had received 10 school-required vaccines as of October, including those against chickenpox, whooping cough, hepatitis B, measles and polio, among others. The only required vaccine that fewer than 95% of Illi-

nois kids received was the meningococcal vaccine, with 94.4% of Illinois children vaccinated.

Though pockets of lower vaccination rates remain in parts of Illinois — including in Chicago for several vaccines — the statewide numbers were an improvement from the previous school year. Across Illinois, rates for all but one of the vaccines rose slightly.

The state's goal is for 95% of kids to be vaccinated — a level that's considered high enough to prevent the spread of infectious diseases and to protect those who cannot be vaccinated.

"Our latest school immunization numbers validate our efforts to make vaccines more accessible," Gov. JB Pritzker said in a statement. "I'm grateful to the Illinois Department of Public Health, the State Board of Education, school administrators, healthcare professionals, and families for their efforts to keep our state's youngest residents healthy, informed, and immunized."

People can look up vaccination rates by school and school district on the state health department's newly updated dashboard.

Areas of Illinois with lower

rates for multiple types of vaccinations include several counties in the northwest corner of the state, as well as in far southern Illinois.

Chicago also had rates below 95% for certain vaccines. In Chicago, about 92.7% of kids received the vaccine that protects against diphtheria, tetanus and whooping cough. About 88.8% had received the meningococcal vaccine; 93.6% had received the polio vaccine; and 92.6% had received a vaccine for older children that also protects against

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Brookfield Zoo union workers go on strike

Teamsters, zoo reps say animals will keep receiving care

By Talia Soglin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Some workers at the Brookfield Zoo walked off the job Monday after labor contract negotiations fell apart, according to their union, the International Brotherhood of Teamsters Local 727.

The Teamsters said all members of the zoo union, includ-

ing those who specialize in caring for the zoo animals, went on strike. The animal care staff will join the strike once an "essential care plan" for the zoo critters has been finalized, the Teamsters said.

The zoo remains open to the public, according to a statement posted to its website Monday, though the Teamsters are urging the public not to cross the picket line.

The union says it's striking over a litany of unfair labor prac-

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Chief union steward and Brookfield Zoo groundskeeper Carrie Sapienza, far right, leads a group of chanting and striking zoo workers on Monday outside the zoo in Brookfield. **ANTONIO PEREZ/TRIBUNE**

Bulls hire new VP of operations

The Bulls named Bryson Graham their new executive vice president of basketball operations, replacing Artūras Karnišovas, whom they fired April 6 along with GM Marc Eversley. **Chicago Sports**

Tax commissioner's DUI trial begins

Cook County Board of Review Commissioner Samantha Steele's long-awaited DUI trial began with prosecutors questioning the police who investigated the crash and arrested her. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

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